(10/12)

This week I spent more time reading about technology usage and utility by informal caregivers, along with organizational caregivers, and the barriers that created the disconnect that similarly occurs in older adults and technology. Two articles that stuck out to me on the topic were Lindeman (2019) and Hassan's (2020) works that both served to identify directions that technology could go to serve the needs of older adults and their caregivers. The two literature reviews categorize the issues; one in terms of emergent themes of impact, whether it be socioeconomic, organizational, technological, and most interesting to me, ethically. In my literature review so far I haven't seen a lot of the sociological or ethical considerations with these issues, which I personally struggled with since the subject matter often provides us with ethical issues. The importance of informed consent, especially as a developing and continuous process with helping older adults, given the steady increase of monitoring technology being used as, albeit useful and powerful, solutions.

The other identifies emerging technologies and their usage to caregivers, along with the mediators and moderators when it comes to usage. The article provides many research questions that should be considered in the field, and provided me with some insight to the prevalent subjects of thought in this specific area of the gerontechnology field.

The other development this week is working on the survey that I had mentioned in the previous reflection. I did some preliminary research on the formulation of survey questions, their structures, and common practices when it comes to survey work. This has driven me to actually hold two questionnaire/surveys: an open-ended pilot survey that I plan on engaging with volunteers in the Newfane Moore Free Library, whose library director Beckley Gaudette I have a relationship with in my personal volunteering. This open-ended pilot will help direct me to the more close-question Likert model survey that I will hold with Valley Village staff.

Finally, I did some work contextualizing and visually laying out the important emerging themes in my research on some large-scale graph paper (seen in Gallery). I did this because I plan on beginning to look and formulate structures for my literature review paper, and will begin outlining the conclusions that I have drawn in these first significant rounds of research. While creating and outlining the beginning of the literature review, I hope I will gain some insight into the gaps in the research that I can leverage in my own research and application in this capstone.

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